



TV Har

You attach your phone and an inbuilt magnifying glass enlarges the picture inches from your eyes. Makes you look like Huckleberry Hound though.



I can haz Karotz

This smart rabbit showcased at CES can play music, give you weather updates, and even respond to voice commands.

and voice control interface was supported by digital content services like Zune, Netflix and Hulu Plus. However, the potential for such an interface is still globally applicable, and maybe 2011 will see Microsoft tying up with Indian service providers to make the Xbox 360 a digital content platform for us as well.

Ballmer also introduced the Avatar Kinect feature, which creates a real-life simulacrum Xbox LIVE Avatar for subscribers using the 3D camera and its facial recognition technology. This technology will also allow the Avatar to reflect not just the person's movements, but also their facial expressions.

Wrapping up, Ballmer spoke about the Kinect and Xbox 360's road ahead:

"You're going to continue to see more fun, more entertainment, and more innovation from our Xbox team in 2011. Xbox today is going where no gaming system has ever gone. Your Xbox is becoming the hub of your living room. It is your gaming system, but it's your movies, it's your TV shows, and it's your sporting events. It's your social interactions, all delivered directly to the biggest screen in your house."

Windows Phone 7

Though the latest Windows mobile operating system has been received with much excitement, there are certain relative shortcomings that are a bit galling in this day and age, from the lack of Bluetooth file transfers to the lack of video calls, true multitasking, copy/paste and Flash/Silverlight in the browser. Most of these omissions will probably be rectified in the coming months with Microsoft's admittedly frequent updates,

if only to play on a level field with Android and iOS, forget catching up.

Ballmer announced Microsoft will be releasing a series of Windows Phone 7 updates over the next few months, and these will bring features like copy/paste, improved multitasking performance, improved camera and OneNote access, enhanced lock and Start screen interface, better Bing integration, increased language support, and more. Unfortunately, what exactly will be present in

perhaps as importantly, all-in, simply how beautiful it really looks."

Microsoft Surface

When Microsoft's Surface was first introduced in 2007, it was met with much excitement, and according to Steven Spielberg, its early concepts were inspiration for Minority Report's futuristic gesture based interface, and not the other way around. It was launched for commercial use in mid-2008, though it only saw adoption by some major com-

The new screen technology is apparently a "major step forward in the surface computing category", and manages to incorporate the original aims of original Surface product (direct interaction, multi-touch contact, a multi-user experience, and object recognition), endowing it with the ability to recognize fingers, hands, text, and even objects, as well as giving it a more flexible form factor. The Surface PC or Samsung SUR40, will now be used in much smaller form factors than tables, such as kiosks. New adopters of the technology were also mentioned.

Qualcomm flashes MSM8660 Snapdragon at CES 2011

2011 marks the year that promises to bring the performance war from desktop computers to cellular devices. And to this end, the likes of Qualcomm, Samsung and Texas Instruments have been slugging it out for awhile. The race for a 1 GHz-plus, mobile CPU, as well as multiple cores is set to reach consumer shores this year. Although the MSM8660 – Qualcomm's latest SoC – had been announced for a while, CES 2011 was the stage chosen to demo it. This SoC consists of two ARM Cortex-A8 cores, (Qualcomm calls them Scorpion cores), and a 45nm, Adreno 220 GPU. The CPU cores run at a blistering 1.2 GHz. Adreno is a name given to the Z430, that was developed by Imageon – the mobile graphics department



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these updates probably won't be revealed until each is available, so don't hold your breath. Many new games were also announced, as well as the speed at which the app store was growing at, which is now up to 5,500 applications.

Ballmer gushed on about just how optimistic he was for Windows Phone 7's future, saying:

"When I get a chance to show people a Windows Phone, the feedback that I hear is very, very gratifying. People tell me how snappy it is, how easy to use, how personal it really feels, and

We're entering a new era of technology for consumers where you'll be able to use Windows anywhere you go, from the small screen to the big screen.

panies, as it was, and is still, prohibitively expensive.

Ballmer wrapped up his keynote speech talking about the next generation of

Microsoft Surface, where the LCD screen-table will be able to "see" without the use of cameras, using PixelSense. This new technology was created in partnership with Samsung.

